

Stuck in Translation: Reflexive Practice in Queer HCI Research from Non-Western Perspectives

Seora Park

Department of Informatics
Indiana University Bloomington
Bloomington, Indiana, USA
seorpark@iu.edu

Tilar A DeVine

Department of Informatics
Indiana University
Bloomington, Indiana, USA
tidevine@iu.edu

Austin L. Toombs

Department of Informatics
Indiana University
Bloomington, Indiana, USA
altoombs@iu.edu

Abstract

We explore the intersectional struggles of a non-Western HCI researcher engaging with LGBTQIA+ women's communities. Through self-reflection, the first author explores how her positionalities shaped engagements with the community, academic audience, and the research itself. While her community affiliation facilitated the early stage of research, it conflicted with her effort to balance the insider-outsider boundaries, creating dilemmas and distress. In parallel, she was discouraged by her attempts to bridge queer theory with HCI, the challenge of relying on articles published in Korean, and publication expectations to identify opportunities for "uniqueness" in addressing local experiences for global audiences. We triangulate the first author's "stuckness" by incorporating the experiences of the research team, connecting contexts and reflecting on the nature of researcher positionality. By articulating the structural challenges of this non-Western Queer HCI researcher, this paper adds specific considerations, analytic lenses, and implications to calls for greater acknowledgment of researcher reflexivity.

CCS Concepts

• **Human-centered computing** → **Empirical studies in HCI**; • **Social and professional topics** → **Sexual orientation**; **Cultural characteristics**.

Keywords

Queer HCI, Self-reflection, Non-Western Epistemology, Researcher-community relationships, Matter of Translation

ACM Reference Format:

Seora Park, Tilar A DeVine, and Austin L. Toombs. 2025. Stuck in Translation: Reflexive Practice in Queer HCI Research from Non-Western Perspectives. In *Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '25)*, April 26–May 01, 2025, Yokohama, Japan. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 9 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3716236>

1 Introduction

As part of what has been described as third-wave paradigms [7, 23], the Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) research communities have centered on intersectionality as "a framework that focuses on how

various dimensions of identity coalesce inseparably and relate to the conditions of one's surroundings, because it supports efforts to situate the relationship between technology and social systems" [45, p. 5412]. As such, the focus on intersectionality in the HCI community has shifted to invite more distinct people from diverse contexts "out there" [47]. Addressing the Euro-American-centric narrow foci of HCI so far, modern research has accelerated a growing number of attempts to explore the lived experiences of individuals and their relations with technology within the context of the Global South [38, 51], Africa [2, 5], and Asia [13, 40].

Furthermore, this epistemological turn calls for researchers' reflection on their own research practices and their engagement with participants in situ. For example, Itchuaqiyah et al. [25] have focused on a more practical guideline that researchers can leverage when engaging with Arctic Indigenous people. They presented a framework for cultural humility for socially just community-engaged research, using the Inuit cultural practice of Nalukataq as a key metaphor. Extending the reflexivity about research practices to publication practices, Kou and colleagues [33] analyzed the politics of titling for CHI publications when representing non-Western vs. Western countries, such as how, when, and why a country is named in paper titles to describe study contexts. Through this critique, they highlighted how such practices can lead to building categories of "normal" and "exotic." The body of work these papers belong within highlights longstanding Euro-American centrism in the knowledge production and distribution process at CHI and calls for an attentive approach to more inclusive and contextually nuanced research practices.

Aligning with the pivot to intersectionality in the HCI community, individuals with more diverse identities have also gradually been invited to participate in HCI research. A notable example is Queer HCI, which involves three overlapping groups: LGBTQIA+ researchers regardless of what they research, those researching LGBTQIA+ individuals, and those leveraging queer theory [48]. Drawing on bodies of work such as Queer Studies, Gender Studies, Transgender Studies, and Feminist Theory, this category of research has become a substantial part of HCI efforts in terms of researchers, user groups, and frameworks.

As attention has increased, the context of Queer HCI research has also expanded. Recently, a growing number of studies in Queer HCI have explored diverse sociocultural contexts, specifically non-Western settings (e.g., [13, 14, 40, 42]). These studies have shown how non-Western LGBTQIA+ communities engage in ongoing negotiations surrounding visibility, stigma, and the intersection of multi-layered identities, which potentially shift focus far away from the kinds of "out-and-proud" portraits that Western discussions

Permission to make digital or hard copies of all or part of this work for personal or classroom use is granted without fee provided that copies are not made or distributed for profit or commercial advantage and that copies bear this notice and the full citation on the first page. Copyrights for third-party components of this work must be honored. For all other uses, contact the owner/author(s).

CHI EA '25, Yokohama, Japan

© 2025 Copyright held by the owner/author(s).

ACM ISBN 979-8-4007-1395-8/25/04

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3716236>

center [30, 37]. To name only a couple of examples, Cui et al. [14] explored how sexual minority women in China leveraged online communities to seek out safe online shelters under censorship. Likewise, Moitra et al. [40] explored how LGBTQIA+ activists in India grappled with difficulties in navigating intersectional identities within a pluralist sociocultural and religious context.

To capture the complexities and the nuanced experiences in those contexts, prior research has stressed the acknowledgment of researchers' positionalities, as a comprehensive quality that encompasses an individual's experiences and background, making up a unique perspective on the world [36]. Such work has emphasized the importance of researchers reflecting on their own standpoints and how they might influence interactions, interpretation, and analysis with the communities they study [17, 24, 47, 51]. By reflecting on our own positions, we can better understand how the intersectional matrix of positions and power shapes both the participants and the researchers, as well as the overall research [17]. This reflection allows us to explore how we can navigate our contributions to HCI knowledge and advocate for social justice with these communities.

Building on the re-framings, shiftings, and de-centering approaches above, we use this paper to provide a critical reflection on the first-person experience of researching and engaging with non-Western LGBTQIA+ communities. The first author of this paper conducted research with South Korean LGBTQIA+ women, exploring how online dating technology regulated their exploratory manifestation of queerness and how such normalization was deeply rooted in the sociocultural norms of Korean society [42]. Through this self-reflection, we illuminate the specific tensions and challenges researchers may encounter when conducting Queer HCI research outside of Western contexts. We also examine how a researcher navigates the dilemmas that arise from a complex set of roles and positionalities throughout the research process. In doing so, we leverage triangulation-focused approaches as an intersubjective standpoint to bridge the "local" experiences with other research contexts [10, 15, 30].

By providing this critical reflection, we contribute to Queer HCI scholarship in three ways:

- (1) We illustrate the vulnerabilities that researchers who hold intersecting roles and positionalities may face in engagement with the subject communities.
- (2) We highlight the unique challenges and struggles in addressing a situated understanding of the complex cultural and social dynamics of non-Western contexts within Queer HCI.
- (3) We emphasize the need for a more nuanced approach to integrating interdisciplinary perspectives from both queer studies and HCI research.

2 Positionality Statements

We provide individual positionality statements for each of the authors. Seora's, in Korean, is further unpacked throughout the remainder of the article in a continued critical reflection. All of the authors' statements are longer than typical positionality statements because we leverage our reflections about the nature of positionality statements throughout the article as well.

Seora. 서라는 인디애나 대학교 블루밍턴의 Department of Informatics에 재학 중인 박사과정 학생이다. 그는 한국의 학부에서 정치학과 정보문화학을 복수 전공했다. 주전공이었던 정치학은 HCI로 진로를 변경하면서 다시는 볼 일이 없을 거라고 생각했는데, 석사 대학원 자기소개서에서부터 박사 SOP까지 진한 정치학적 관점이 녹아 들어있다는 평을 반복적으로 받아서 당황하는 중이다. 지금은 스스로의 기저에 있는 정치학적 지향을 받아들이고, HCI의 인식론과 방법론과 조화롭게 융합하는 방법을 연습 중이다.

서라는 한국에서 학사와 석사를 거치면서 Assistive technology, Personal tracking, Health informatics, 그리고 Queer HCI 연구를 진행해왔다. 그는 항상 연구를 통한 참여자 현장과의 연결을 중요시해왔고, 그 이유 때문인지 스스로가 속하거나 직간접적으로 경험한 바가 있는 맥락의 참여자들에 대한 연구를 진행해왔다. 지금까지는 현장과의 친연성이 그가 연구에 몰입하는 데 큰 동기이자 기회로 작용했는데, 전혀 개인적인 커뮤니티나 배경이 없는 낯선 나라에서 새 커리어를 시작하게 된 지금, 스스로의 정체성이나 커뮤니티 소속을 자원으로 삼지 않고 앞으로 어떤 방식으로 어떤 연구를 해나가야 할지에 대해서 고민하고 있다.

그는 모든 HCI 교육과 연구 경험에서 영어를 제 1언어로서 수행하고 훈련해왔다. 그러나 이 성명문은 영어로는 이름을 제외하고는 잘 쓰여지지 않아서, 한국어로 작성한다.¹

Tilar. Tilar is a PhD student in the Department of Informatics at Indiana University Bloomington. Her background is in Web Design and her industry background in user research has fueled her passion for HCI research regarding intersectionality and online communities. As a black woman, her experiences include navigating issues of race and identity online. While her bisexual identity has very little to do with her work, it feels necessary to bring it up, given the nature of this paper.

For Tilar, the issue of positionality statements is two-fold. On the one hand, it is important for her to state her identity as a Black woman because it is integral to her identity as a person and an academic. Topics of race are central to her work, making this act of self-disclosure much more natural and straightforward. This act of self-disclosure helps better understand why she's pursuing these topics and the unique perspective she brings to these projects.

¹Seora is a PhD student in the Department of Informatics at Indiana University Bloomington. She earned her bachelor's in political science and information science. She used to think she would never meet again with PoliSci when she shifted her career to HCI. However, it keeps embarrassing her when the audience often remarks on how they could feel her strong roots in PoliSci after reading her master's application letter, PhD's statement of purpose, and papers. Currently, she is working on embracing this underlying orientation and bridging it with HCI epistemology and methodology.

Seora has participated in and led research on assistive technology, personal tracking, health informatics, and Queer HCI throughout her bachelor's and master's in Korea. Her academic endeavors have always been centered on reciprocal relations with the communities on the ground. This approach has often involved studying contexts she personally belonged to or participated in as a member and/or an ally. So far, her affinity for the field has been a major source of motivation and opportunity for her research. However, as she begins a new career in a foreign country with no prior personal ties or community background, she is figuring out what kinds of research to engage in and exploring various approaches that include, but are not limited to, those based on her own identities and affiliations.

While she trained in English for all of her education and research in HCI, this statement is written in Korean because she couldn't start writing at all for days, except her name, when trying to write it in English. (Translated by the first author)

When thinking about sexuality, however, she has struggled with whether or not to disclose her bisexual identity. Due to the amount of bi-phobia that exists inside and outside of queer spaces, she doesn't feel welcome there. Bisexuality is commonly characterized as "quirky straight" or "one stop on the way to being gay/lesbian." Because she is in a hetero-normative relationship, it feels like there's a pressure to not speak on queer issues. Or that she'd need to prove her queerness to participate. That she'd need to recount her previous experiences with women to prove that she wasn't just questioning or co-opting a marginalized identity. The incessant need to prove her queerness has always kept her on the outskirts of queer communities, whether personal or academic. For her, it often feels as though there's an unspoken rule that you have to be a certain level of queer to participate in the academic or social discourse in the space that she doesn't meet. This makes this act of self-disclosure not only difficult, but incredibly uncomfortable.

Austin. Austin is an Associate Professor in the Department of Informatics at Indiana University Bloomington. His background is in Computer Science and Mathematics, which often sneaks into how he conceptualizes, analyzes, and interprets his HCI research about how communities and tight-knit groups use technology. Growing up as an Army Brat, he spent much of his childhood moving frequently and living on small military bases, which cultivated an early interest in understanding how people form connections and build community under constrained and transient circumstances. These experiences reveal much more about the epistemological influences that guide Austin's scholarship than the fact that he is gay. However, this paper's queer themes create a pressure for Austin to make his sexuality relevant.

Austin has wrestled with how positionality statements often appear as identity-based claims to authority. Such statements sometimes imply that researchers must disclose certain aspects of their identity to justify their legitimacy in studying particular topics. For Austin, this tension is particularly acute because, while he is gay, he does not consider his sexuality central to his research, nor does he study topics directly tied to queer topics. He often dismisses his own relevance to Queer HCI spaces by joking that he "might as well join a group for tall academics" (though he recognizes the importance of those spaces for others). Austin's early exposure to Queer HCI during graduate school left him feeling out of place, as the discussions often focused on sexuality in ways that didn't resonate with him. He initially wondered if this disinterest stemmed from internalized homophobia, but now he sees it as part of a broader stance: a desire to live as though being transparently and visibly gay does not matter, not because it isn't important but because it shouldn't have to be important. He acknowledges that this position can be interpreted as either problematic or liberating, depending on the lens applied. It reflects an ongoing negotiation with his own identity and its relevance to his professional work.

To be transparent, Austin has engaged with very little queer theory and is far from an expert. His experiences arguing with homophobic acquaintances and coworkers are more relevant than any assumed authority about Austin's ability to critically interpret what other queer people might be experiencing outside of that specific kind of shared experience. While these experiences shape how he approaches this kind of work, he resists framing them

as a source of authority. This positionality statement, like others in this paper, aims to reflect on the cultural, epistemological, and experiential influences that inform Austin's perspectives. Rather than using identity as a claim of legitimacy, he hopes to foreground the tensions and complexities of positionality itself; researchers must constantly navigate the pressure to disclose, the desire to protect personal boundaries, and the need to situate their work in ways that are honest and meaningful.

3 Self-Reflection

In this section, we present a self-reflection on conducting research on queer HCI within non-Western contexts. Seora writes this section in first-person, elaborating on her personal experiences, thoughts, and struggles she experienced during the research process for the previous Queer HCI study on the technology use of queer Korean women. She organizes this reflection into sections that focus on the role her own identities play in her research ("3.1 Intersectional"), her struggle with bridging disciplinary approaches and knowledge to accomplish her research goals ("3.2 Interdisciplinary"), and her challenge with representing the culturally salient elements of her research context in Korea to a primarily Western audience ("3.3 International.") Austin and Tilar provide additional perspectives based on their own experiences as sounding boards, for triangulation, and to help demonstrate initial ways that Seora's experiences can translate to other diverse contexts relevant to the HCI community. Their perspectives are added as footnotes, to ensure that Seora's experiences are appropriately centered. All names and some circumstances have been obscured or omitted for anonymity.

3.1 Intersectional: Wrestling with the insider-outsider boundary in relation to the subject community

How does one obtain the legitimate authority or "qualifications" to interpret a context or community, particularly those in marginalized situations? How can I maintain a balance between being an observer and being sufficiently immersed in the context to avoid superficially objectifying it? Before commencing the research, I was pretty familiar with the Korean queer women's community. I had numerous direct and indirect engagements with the communities, from working and volunteering experiences in various organizations to personal networks and relationships as an ally and a community member. This long involvement allowed me to become familiar with the culture, norms, and common practices of those communities, especially as it relates to relationship building and dating, the primary topic of the study.

My familiarity with the community enabled me to leverage what I already knew to construct the overall study design, including setting the focus of the study, developing interview questions, and accessing participants. For example, multiple empirical cases of my and my friends' failed dating experiences convinced me of the need for a study like mine, allowing me to bypass a lengthy "context justification" process in order to focus on investigating dating technology's impact on relationship building and providing alternative platform suggestions. Also, interview protocols could be built on easily as just reflecting on our previous dating experiences. In recruiting, I could access the community through the exclusive

platform for queer Korean women, which I already registered in, helping to recruit 17 participants in a short period of time.

However, throughout the research process, I found it challenging to detach my personal experiences and perceptions from the research, which I assumed at the time was an important part of conducting an “objective” and rigorous study. The psychological intimacy I had with this community hindered me from sustaining the kind of safe and ethical distance from my participants that I thought I needed to embody as an “impartial observer.” During interviews, for example, I found myself having desires to indirectly disclose my queerness to participants by sharing personal stories about failed dating or venting about weird norms in this community together with them. I personally thought this approach might help to build a rapport with participants, lower their psychological barriers, and offer safe environments, eventually facilitating their self-disclosure of personal histories².

However, simultaneously, I realized that the desire to express my affinity with this community made not only the participants but also myself feel less vulnerable. This is because I knew how susceptible this community is to harassment and objectification by strangers. I felt strongly uncomfortable about potentially being perceived as an “external observer” who was trying to exploit my participants’ marginalized status within this conservative Korean society, because I knew that perception could diminish my authenticity. Damaged authenticity could genuinely discourage my motivation. In other words, if there was even a chance that they might see me as a researcher who thinks, “Queer people’s lives are miserable enough to make a paper about it!,” then I would rather cease this research altogether³. In that sense, my desire to disclose how I identify to participants naturally emerged in my mind as a kind of defensive mechanism to excuse myself from the potential damage to my authenticity. However, I still grappled with the ethical tension I felt about my responsibility to maintain a distance from the subject in order to avoid overly influencing participants’ answers by altering their comfort.

In the process of data interpretation after interviews, I still recognized that my lived experiences that I naturally developed as belonging to and engaging with this community influenced how I steered the interviews and interpreted their data. My background

knowledge was rooted in multiple sources across private, interpersonal, and communal lives, making it hard to establish thorough academic language. This informal knowledge keeps influencing my interpretation, urging me to read more than what the collected data actually said.

I encountered another conflicting desire during the analysis when I observed biased and prejudiced behaviors from participants. I found myself oscillating between a feeling to excuse their remarks and a feeling of ethically pointing out what was wrong⁴. For example, some participants explicitly stated that they did not want to meet individuals with specific appearances, body shapes, ages, sexual orientations, and gender identities on dating apps. Notably, almost half of the participants expressed discomfort with meeting with trans people on dating apps, citing rumors or personal experiences where male intruders falsely pretended to be trans to harass users. While I recognized that these views were definitely discriminatory, I struggled with how to describe such unjust statements. I felt that simply reporting what I heard as it was could come across as blaming and judging the participants. Furthermore, I was also confused about what could be “objective” of their statements and whether my confusion stemmed from my psychological attachment to these participants. Did I not want to acknowledge that people within a community I respect hold these kinds of views that did not align with mine?

While I struggled in several ways with setting a variable distance with the community, a reviewer of the article suggested that I should mention the impact that a lack of queer women on the research team could have on the findings. How could I validate my affinity to this community without coming out through the paper?

3.2 Interdisciplinary: Straddling different fields, and never feeling fully contributive

The previous study was strongly based on the theoretical framework of queerness, especially inspired by the affective theorists such as Lauren Berlant (e.g., [6]), Michael Warner (e.g., [52]), and Sara Ahmed (e.g., [3]). Initial work for that study analyzed the affordances of dating applications for LGBTQIA+ women in Korea in criticizing the role of technology design in normalizing queer affects, such as cruel optimism, fetishized intimacy, and promise of happiness. While the theoretical backgrounds were a bit blurred during polishing the full paper, groundings on queer theories remained in the main thesis. For example, queerness, a compelling quality of a non-(hetero)normative way of life, was a key concept leading the whole findings and discussion of the paper, helping me claim how the cishetero-centric technology design regulated the open and exploratory experience of queerness to the LGBTQ+ community.

²Austin: Self-disclosure is a powerful interview technique, but it’s not something I plan for ahead of time. Reflecting on when and how I use this approach, I seem to have two kinds of self-disclosure “moments”: 1) making participants feel more comfortable, such as with participants who initially seem self-conscious about how their gaming hobby is their primary social outlet or with participants who might want to vent about something but they are not yet sure if I’m a safe person to vent to; and 2) when I’m subtly “coming out” to participants by talking about “my husband,” which I will do if I think a participant is trying to suss me out before opening up about their own experiences or if I think a participant might say something homophobic and I want to head them off. In that last case, I worry about overly influencing what my participants say and about the candid responses I miss out on. However, my long-standing goal of being visibly and transparently gay to help normalize queer identities wins out.

³Tilar: Grappling with authenticity, especially when working with marginalized groups, has been something I’ve struggled with in research. On the one hand, my race is something that can contribute positively to certain groups trusting me more, but issues like socioeconomic status isn’t something you can exactly disclose. I worry constantly about how to let my participants know I’m not some “out of touch, uppity” girl that’s coming to “save” them like so many others have before me when working in these spaces. Someone who comes into a lower class neighborhood to take photos and then leave, creating no real or lasting change. My community has been used as props to prove diversity and/or racial equality so often that it can be incredibly difficult to know when and how to self disclose to them.

⁴Austin: Me too! In my dissertation I wrote about the difficulty of maintaining distance when my participants would say homophobic things. An early draft of my “From Empathy to Care” paper included similar examples, but we rewrote those examples because we were not sure if we should mention my sexuality in that paper. The text we ended up using was, “Being dependent on these relationships also includes an inherent vulnerability, as with any relationships, to potential emotional distress. For Austin, this included: feeling left out or disappointed when participants did not include him in exciting projects or show up when they said they would; feeling discouraged when participants would dismiss his input in an intellectual discussion, and being offended by insensitive remarks that were not directed toward him but did implicate him” [50].

As such, while applying the theoretical concept concretely was crucial for me to gather feedback from the relevant disciplines, I struggled with finding a place for comprehensive feedback. I could only seem to get partial feedback: methodological and analytic advice from the HCI fields (e.g., how to analyze qualitative data), and theoretical feedback from gender studies (e.g., what the specific queer theories say about queerness). However, there existed an explicit gap between these sets of feedback due to different frameworks and assumptions of the disciplines. For example, I had no idea what it meant to apply affective theories, which have been developed predominantly to discuss the nation-state level of hegemony and power dynamics, to an individual level of everyday experiences. I remained unsure of if I was using and contextualizing queer theories well in viewing HCI-oriented user experiences. Where could I find a discussion about “bridging queer theory in HCI” or vice versa?

I felt like the entire responsibility for negotiating and reconciling between different knowledge bases and disciplinary assumptions rested on my shoulders despite me being just a junior researcher. In the process of refining the research into the language that was familiar to HCI readers, compromises, polishing, and tone-downing led to feelings of guilt, shame, and helplessness. If I went too deeply into queer theory, it wouldn’t be accessible or acceptable to HCI audiences. But if I didn’t, my thesis and theoretical application seemed inadequate to my peers from queer studies.

Unfortunately, it did play out how I worried it might. Two months after I presented my paper at the CHI 2024 conference, I volunteered to present at a Korean LGBTQIA research conference. I was still eager to have my theoretical approach reviewed (and hopefully validated) from the perspective of queer and gender studies researchers, even after the CHI audience accepted and published my paper. Not surprisingly, I received multiple questions and critiques about my discussion, theoretical groundings, and fundamental approaches from the queer studies audience.

This made me unconfident in my work by weakening how I understood my contributions to both fields⁵. I expected to contribute to the HCI communities in proving the value of queer theories as a set of analytic language, but my application of theories was not as thorough or well-situated as it could have been, which raised significant questions from the theoretical fields. Also, I wanted to introduce a new, technological approach to queer theories at the conference, which, in turn, were too unfamiliar to be connected to their established epistemologies. Attempting to build this bridge confused me about where and how to find the balance between a diffused range of epistemologies, assumptions, and backgrounds in order to situate my contributions.

3.3 International: Navigating local specificity and broader impact

Since my CHI 2024 paper deeply discussed Korean culture and societal norms to contextualize participants’ experiences, articulating the characteristics of Korean society was crucial. Specifically, it was necessary to explain how Korean society marginalizes LGBTQIA+

individuals and women institutionally and culturally and how that oppression comprehensively impacts their lived experiences. I was born and raised in that society, so I could naturally sense its complexities. However, I still needed to concretize it into academic language since this paper was targeting a global audience who may be unfamiliar with Korean society.

In that process, I encountered a notable lack of references that I could draw upon to address this need, particularly in English work published in international journals. While there was substantial Korean literature that critically examined the structural matrix of domination in Korean contexts, I felt uncertain about citing these as the primary resources to be accepted in a venue like CHI. I worried that referencing Korean work might be perceived as less academically rigorous or impactful, given its relatively low accessibility and visibility within global academia. As such, although I frequently consulted Korean literature to develop my initial ideas, I often found myself re-searching for similar English-language work that covered related themes or was cited in the Korean sources. If there were no comparable articles available in English, I often did not choose to cite them in the paper even though some Korean literature has significantly influenced my explorations.

This meant that I might need to give up including some key language that I use to express what and how I had been building my thoughts and, to some extent, compromises the depth of my arguments. Although it may not apply universally to all Korean HCI communities, this extra labor has been a familiar practice for me throughout my learning and training in HCI research within Korea, and I feel that I would choose to do it again to make my paper more acceptable and accessible to a global audience. As of now, to my understanding, the academic authority of individual work is primarily assessed by its publishability, and the scene that has established the structure of knowledge production is mostly centered around English-language users and Western epistemology. In this context, I feel that negotiating between the depth of language that I could employ in my analysis and the global acceptability of the paper is inevitable, even though I remain unsure whether my English references to Korean society adequately support my conceptualization of its nuanced sociocultural milieu. This negotiation is likely a shared challenge for researchers exploring “local” contexts, especially in regions where English is not the native language.

Conducting the very first study in an underexplored context carries the inherent risk of overrepresentation⁶. That means that there is a danger that the struggles or challenges I highlighted could be misunderstood as inherent and fixed traits of the society or community, leading to reductive generalizations. If my work overemphasized challenges in my participants’ lived experiences, it might risk reifying the local community as innately frustrating and miserable. While I sought to avoid depicting the community in a shallow way—either solely negative or always positive and proud—it was still critical to highlight the real struggles of my participants’ lived experiences.

⁵Austin: This feels very familiar to me, and I think I’ve been told this is part of HCI’s “stepchild syndrome,” in that we are often translating from other, older disciplines. Since those translation activities involve simplifications sometimes, or at least imperfect fits in many instances, purists from the donating fields seem to look down on what we do.

⁶Austin: I remember being pretty concerned about some of my earlier hackerspace work, because it seemed like the potential to misrepresent their communities was quite high. Leaning into empirical descriptions and thicker forms of qualitative research helped me avoid this issue to some extent by sidestepping any kind of misunderstood generalizations

This dilemma resonated with a comment that I recurrently received from various reviewers and peers, urging me to articulate the “unique” experiences of queer women compared to hetero/queer men or the “original” non-Western experiences compared to their Western counterparts. But what exactly constitutes a “unique experience” for queer women? Must it always involve some distinctly different or standout experiences compared to other groups in terms of gender, sexuality, and geopolitical locations?

These experiences have helped me solidify questions about a researcher’s role in representing the subjects’ subjective experiences, which I hope to be able to more explicitly consider in my future projects. A researcher holds the power to interpret and represent participant experiences, but does she truly have the legitimate right or appropriate ethics to do so? Even with a “rightful” intention, is it ethical? Can her intention account for this power imbalance? Clifford Geertz, Linda Tuhiwai Smith, and E. E. Evans-Pritchard are just a few scholars who ask questions about these kinds of power imbalances, our abilities to represent others, and the mechanisms we can employ to collaborate with participants in the representation process [18, 21, 53]. Placing these considerations in context with HCI approaches and queer theory frameworks may open up space to understand how technologies represent identities that resist categorization or provide avenues that enable people to voice their discomfort with how their community is represented in a research project.

4 Discussion

In this section, we reflect on the intersecting matrix of stuckness embedded in an experience of conducting non-Western Queer HCI that was introduced in the previous section. Situating these impasses in previous work from HCI, STS, and queer studies, we discuss the implications for the HCI community in addressing non-Western and Queer HCI work. We also discuss self-reflection and triangulation as critical methods to provide a lens that enables researchers to speak out about structural challenges during their research process and expand the discussions with other diverse research contexts.

In the previous section, we introduced the struggle that the first author went through when setting various distances with the subjects of analysis. The first author adhered to her own ethical framework at the time, emphasizing the importance of impartiality throughout the entire process of conducting research. This framework included considerations not to influence or prime subjects’ responses during interviews or to maintain “objectivity” when interpreting their data. However, her ethics led to a dilemma in relation to her own membership. She found her own desire to disclose her psychological affinity with the communities to participants and avoid negative descriptions about the communities, which might discourage her impartiality.

While adhering to maintaining the distance from the field for the sake of impartiality is neither possible nor desirable in reflexive ethnographic research (see [8, 20, 27, 44]), the first author’s struggles in balancing between participating and observing reveal how an individual researcher continues to grapple with these negotiations in their in-situ engagement with the field. Scholarship in ethnographic research has long recognized that participation and membership exist on a spectrum as situated, requiring a researcher

to constantly navigate decisions about the extent, form, and nature of their involvement with participants at every moment of engagement [9, 41, 49]. In this self-reflection, the first author’s dual positionalities as a researcher and a community member complicated her efforts to navigate an ethical and safe distance for both of them. Her oscillating reflection notably revealed that when researchers feel an emotional affinity and have a membership with the community under research, this shared identity can make them grapple with a dilemma between being a third-party researcher and feeling inclusive as a “good” member. Toombs and his colleagues [50] also introduced how the bonds and shared senses of identity between researchers and participants can lead to ethical tension and emotional distress in researchers. In their critical reflection on research-through-design projects, researchers often oscillated between being an impartial third party and being a caring member of the community. Likewise, Liang et al. [36] illustrated some experiences of HCI researchers who shared identity with the participants they worked with and their ethical endeavors not to overly import their own personal experiences and perspectives into research, specifically in the process of interpretation.

While this negotiation between the insider-outsider boundary during intimate engagement with the field communities is common, the first author’s struggle for balance is more rooted in the structural marginalization of non-Western LGBTQIA+ communities. It still remains common for LGBTQIA+ individuals in South Korea to be discriminated against in a variety of social spheres due to strongly patriarchal and collective societal milieu [28, 32, 43]. In this context, LGBTQIA+ women, who challenge both heteronormative family ideologies and patriarchal gender expectations, experience a dual layer of marginalization [11]. As such, they have sought to develop private and concealed communities with anonymous memberships to block strangers rigidly and bypass unwanted outings [22, 26, 28].

These strict community norms adhering to closed memberships may intensify the researcher’s sense of obligation to validate her identity. Perhaps the first author may internalize such obligations as a community member even though participants did not explicitly require her to do so. Or her concerns may really exist. According to reflective prior studies, the current allyship practices with marginalized communities in HCI often present a possibility to show self-serving, performative, or “empty” allyships [36]. At the same time, researchers looking into the “local” communities claim substantial discretionary power in representing communities [19]. Grappling with the dual privileges, the first author’s experiences illustrate how the local context of research practice can significantly shape the ethical burdens of researchers, heightening their emotional vulnerabilities.

What keeps non-Western HCI researchers stuck is that their epistemology and knowledge are built upon “imported theories” when describing the lived experiences of each local context. In the first author’s reflection, she addressed the challenge of navigating academic resources and audiences in her research, including exploring relevant literature and obtaining opportunities for pertinent feedback and discussions. The lack of visibility of references in global academia discouraged her from referring to substantial work in Korean and led her to be stuck in the excessive labor of translation.

As is well known, in studies exploring the social lives of people, the role of language has been emphasized in shaping and creating the characterization, differentiation, and universalization of human understanding of social experiences [2, 54]. In that sense, local academic discourses provide valuable perspectives and analytical frameworks grounded in situated histories and epistemologies. Engaging with them thus should be a required part of conducting such work. When researchers represent the lived experiences of locals through linguistic frameworks built upon entirely different contexts and histories, they may risk misrepresentation or distortions. If we connect this to the practical choices researchers make when aiming to produce a more widely accepted manuscript, the challenge goes beyond mere translation. As the first author shared, the marginalization of non-English contributions may already be structurally ingrained in studies exploring non-English contexts.

Encouragingly, a growing number of research in the HCI communities has included diverse languages to highlight the original values in HCI epistemologies and methodologies (e.g., [2, 4, 25, 31]). However, non-Western Queer HCI studies still grapple with the same limitation in analytic language. A majority of HCI work discussing queerness is predominantly espoused in the Global North and Western discourses [40], since the concept of queerness has been conceptualized as a comprehensive quality of non-normativity [16, 42, 52] or individuals “out-and-proud” built upon the Western-centric framework of liberal citizenship [30, 37]. This paradoxically obscures LGBTQIA+ individuals who have to endure the label of queer identity as “a site of trauma and survival,” such as those of the Middle East, North Africa, and Asia [1, 29, 34]. Given that queer individuals from varying global contexts remain negotiating between visibility and invisibility as “flying under the gaydar” [30, 37], the fixed framework assuming one aspect of queerness can lead to the gap for researchers in navigating situated implications, roles, and meanings through the lived experiences of local communities [30, 38, 39].

However, as the first author is concerned, focusing solely on the structural challenges as a differentiating standpoint from the Western “out-and-proud” milieu can also lead to “exoticizing the other,” stabilizing different or strange aspects of non-Westerners [19, 33]. In this context, the stuckness of local queer HCI research raises questions about what implications it can leave while navigating structural limitations of community engagement and language use. What should be provided, and in what form, to enable this body of work to contribute to the HCI knowledge production, while avoiding biased representations?

One possible approach is to critically examine the assumptions underlying how local-global research is positioned in HCI and re-frame our expectations toward its depth and contextual richness, moving beyond the expectation of uniqueness. Choi [12] discussed the limitations of focusing solely on “unique” experiences, particularly in societies built on imported technologies. As most “newly industrialized” countries did, most technologies in modern Korea were aggressively and institutionally imported from other industrialized countries, such as Japan and the United States. In that context, Choi [12] argued that addressing only unique technology designs and experiences significantly limited efforts to capture the nuanced complexities of such a societal milieu. This resonates with

the first author’s experience of being asked to highlight the uniqueness of experiences of queer Korean women when using online dating technologies, which were imported both from the U.S. to Korea and from heterosexual communities to queer communities. In the HCI community, Kou and colleagues [33] identified similar patterns in difference-making in HCI by revealing how publication titles are more likely to include the names of non-Western countries compared to their Western counterparts. This uneven expectation reproduces disciplinary constructions of normal and exotic and fails to engage with heterogeneity.

This is echoed by Taylor’s [47] critical call for moving beyond Euro-American centrism in HCI research, which urges us to look “out there” by paying attention to what is going on “in here,” setting a researcher as a standpoint of HCI knowledge production. In other words, this is a critical turn to “*see how we might examine a world from ‘inside,’ from ‘right here’ ... (as) an invitation to shift ourselves into the frame of analysis and to apply care and concern for what, exactly, is going on around us*” [47, p. 693].

Starting from “right here” requires researchers’ reflexivity on their situated positionality and its impact as a standpoint of analysis not just for the local context at hand, but also how their positionality impacts the multi-layered translation work that takes place (i.e., translating between contexts, disciplines, and also personal epistemologies). By reflecting on one’s own possible biases, their role in power relations, and how these factors might influence their work [36], we can acknowledge the complexities not only “out there” but also “in here” transparently. In this regard, this paper’s self-reflection provides an insightful example of addressing “right here” orientations by revealing the situated experiences of ethical tensions, emotional dilemmas, and power imbalance between researchers and communities, academic audiences, and society. Self-reflection enables HCI researchers and practitioners to identify and situate a saturated intersecting system of power in an in-situ context [17].

Specifically, a positionality statement can be one of the spaces to address a researcher’s navigation of reflexivity [2]. While prior work pointed out that positionality statements paradoxically appear as proving the authors’ legitimacy and exempting them from addressing the implications of their positionality and discursive power over the other, just by listing identities [46], our initial outline of positionality statements above claims our complex, fluid, and deeply intersectional identities can have diverse, often contradicting implications on our research. We approach author positionality as a reflection on how the way we translate our perspectives and experiences subsequently shapes our engagement with a particular study.

Moreover, we need more public space to speak out about the structural stuckness of non-Western researchers to amplify their voices and highlight their challenges. For example, special interest groups (SIGs) or workshops on non-Western research experiences could provide unique encounters to start thinking differently about how our lived experiences affect our worldviews and how our ontological and epistemological beliefs influence how we conduct research [24, 35]. Within such cross-cultural engagements, we can leverage intersubjectivity among researchers through triangulation-focused approaches [10, 15, 30], with which this work bridged the local with diverse contexts of researchers.

We attempt to solidify the concerns identified above in the following list of questions, which we propose can help shape the initial plans for a research project as well as how it is written for publication. While these are just a starting place, we hope they can help others who also grapple with the kinds of dilemmas presented above.

- What kind of relationship should I and can I establish with the community? How does this relationship shape opportunities and challenges for the research, myself as a researcher, and the community?
- How do I ensure that I am not overgeneralizing or stereotyping the community I am studying?
- What assumptions might I be making about the relevance of my identity to the research context, and how can I critically examine these assumptions?
- What opportunities exist for my work to foster dialogue between disciplines, and how can I highlight these in my writing?
- Am I considering the different epistemological and cultural expectations of the audiences I am addressing (e.g., Western and non-Western)?
- How can I further explore and leverage the value of situated knowledge from relevant local literature or perspectives, even if they are less visible in global academic discourse?
- Am I providing my participants, as well as community members who were not my participants, opportunities to resist or respond to my attempts to represent them?

5 Conclusion

This paper provided a self-reflection of a non-Western researcher who engaged with LGBTQIA+ women's communities throughout the process of research. While the first author's affinity and membership in the community facilitated the early stage of research, they also brought ethical dilemmas, particularly when balancing the roles of an impartial researcher and an authentic community member. Navigating the appropriate audiences to bridge queer theory with HCI applications further posed challenges, especially given the different epistemological backgrounds and distinct contributions within these fields. The first author acknowledged the uncertainty in defining concrete contributions not only for this work but also for her future endeavors. Lastly, the lack of visibility of local resources and an expectation of uniqueness from the global audiences created tensions, leading to compromises between discursive depth and perceived international acceptability. These pressures also risked overrepresenting the structural marginalization of the community, reinforcing reductive narratives. In addressing these challenges, we employed investigator triangulation as a method for reflexivity that goes beyond merely listing positionalities. Through these reflections and methods, we explored the intersectional matrix of stuckness faced by non-Western Queer HCI researchers. This work underscores the significance of addressing "right here" reflexivity as a means to position researchers within a standpoint of analysis, fostering more nuanced and contextually grounded contributions to HCI scholarship.

References

- [1] Giuseppe Acconcia, Aurora Perego, and Lorenza Perini. 2024. LGBTQ activism in repressive contexts: The struggle for (in) visibility in Egypt, Tunisia and Turkey. *Social Movement Studies* 23, 2 (2024), 207–225.
- [2] Muhammad Sadi Adamu. 2020. Adopting an African standpoint in HCI4D: A provocation. In *Extended abstracts of the 2020 CHI Conference on human factors in computing systems*. 1–8.
- [3] Sara Ahmed. 2013. *The cultural politics of emotion*. routledge.
- [4] Yoko Akama, Ann Light, and Takahito Kamihiro. 2020. Expanding participation to design with more-than-human concerns. In *Proceedings of the 16th Participatory Design Conference 2020-Participation (s) Otherwise-Volume 1*. 1–11.
- [5] Kagonyi Awori, Frank Vetere, and Wally Smith. 2015. Transnationalism, indigenous knowledge and technology: Insights from the Kenyan diaspora. In *Proceedings of the 33rd annual ACM conference on human factors in computing systems*. 3759–3768.
- [6] Lauren Berlant and Michael Warner. 1998. Sex in Public. *Critical Inquiry* 24, 2 (1998), 547–566.
- [7] Susanne Bødker. 2006. When second wave HCI meets third wave challenges. In *Proceedings of the 4th Nordic conference on Human-computer interaction: changing roles*. 1–8.
- [8] Michael Burawoy. 1998. Critical sociology: A dialogue between two sciences. *Contemporary Sociology* 27, 1 (1998), 12–20.
- [9] Martina Angela Caretta. 2015. Situated knowledge in cross-cultural, cross-language research: a collaborative reflexive analysis of researcher, assistant and participant subjectivities. *Qualitative Research* 15, 4 (2015), 489–505.
- [10] Nancy Carter. 2014. The use of triangulation in qualitative research. *Number 5/September 2014* 41, 5 (2014), 545–547.
- [11] Eunjo Cho. 2016. Making the 'modern' family: The discourse of sexuality in the Family Planning Program in South Korea. *Sexualities* 19, 7 (2016), 802–818.
- [12] Hyungsub Choi. 2017. The social construction of imported technologies: Reflections on the social history of technology in modern Korea. *Technology and Culture* 58, 4 (2017), 905–920.
- [13] Yichao Cui, Naomi Yamashita, and Yi-Chieh Lee. 2022. "We Gather Together We Collaborate Together": Exploring the Challenges and Strategies of Chinese Lesbian and Bisexual Women's Online Communities on Weibo. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 6, CSCW2, Article 423 (nov 2022), 31 pages. doi:10.1145/3555148
- [14] Yichao Cui, Naomi Yamashita, Mingjie Liu, and Yi-Chieh Lee. [n. d.]. "So Close, yet So Far": Exploring Sexual-minority Women's Relationship-building via Online Dating in China. In *CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. ACM. doi:10.1145/3491102.3517624
- [15] Norman K Denzin. 2007. Triangulation. *The Blackwell encyclopedia of sociology* (2007).
- [16] Steven Epstein. 1994. A Queer Encounter: Sociology and the Study of Sexuality. *Sociological Theory* 12, 2 (1994), 188–202. doi:10.2307/201864
- [17] Sheena Erete, Yolanda Rankin, and Jakita Thomas. 2023. A method to the madness: Applying an intersectional analysis of structural oppression and power in HCI and design. *ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction* 30, 2 (2023), 1–45.
- [18] Edward Evan Evans-Pritchard. 1940. *The Nuer: A description of the modes of livelihood and political institutions of a Nilotic people*. Clarendon Press.
- [19] Pedro Ferreira. 2024. Examining the "Local" in ICT4D: A Postcolonial Perspective on Participation. In *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 1–13.
- [20] Gary Alan Fine. 1993. Ten lies of ethnography: Moral dilemmas of field research. *Journal of contemporary ethnography* 22, 3 (1993), 267–294.
- [21] Clifford Geertz. 2017. *The interpretation of cultures*. Basic books.
- [22] Korean Gay Men's Human Rights Group. 2014. *Key Results South Korean LGBTI Community Social Needs Assessment Survey*. Report. Korean Gay Men's Human Rights Group. <https://chingusai.net/xe/library/416855>
- [23] Steve Harrison, Deborah Tatar, and Phoebe Sengers. 2007. The three paradigms of HCI. In *Alt. Chi. Session at the SIGCHI Conference on human factors in computing systems San Jose, California, USA*. 1–18.
- [24] Andrew Gary Darwin Holmes. 2020. Researcher Positionality—A Consideration of Its Influence and Place in Qualitative Research—A New Researcher Guide. *Shanlax International Journal of Education* 8, 4 (2020), 1–10.
- [25] Cana Uluak Itchuaqiyag, Chris A Lindgren, and Corina Qaagraq Kramer. 2023. Decolonizing Community-Engaged Research: Designing CER with Cultural Humility as a Foundational Value. *Communication Design Quarterly Review* 11, 3 (2023), 12–20.
- [26] Seong-jo Jeong and Yonglim Choung. 2022. LGBTQ Youth and Safe Space: Alternative Spaces Created by the Excluded. *Space and Environment* 80 (2022), 103–141.
- [27] Jeffrey C Johnson, Christine Avenarius, and Jack Weatherford. 2006. The active participant-observer: Applying social role analysis to participant observation. *Field methods* 18, 2 (2006), 111–134.
- [28] Chelle Jones. 2020. Balancing safety and visibility: Lesbian community building strategies in South Korea. *Journal of lesbian studies* 24, 3 (2020), 272–285.

- [29] Min-Woo Jung. 2012. Queer Theory, Sad Native Language. *Korean Journal of Cultural Sociology* 13 (2012), 53–100.
- [30] Gopinath Kannabiran. 2022. Flying under the gaydar. *Interactions* 29, 3 (2022), 24–26.
- [31] Gereon Koch Kapuire, Daniel G Cabrero, Colin Stanley, and Heike Winschiers-Theophilus. 2015. Framing technology design in Ubuntu: two locales in pastoral Namibia. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Australian Special Interest Group for Computer Human Interaction*. 212–216.
- [32] Eunha Kim, Haebek Kim, and Kahee Lee. 2022. A qualitative investigation of the romantic relationship experiences of South Korean lesbians in early adulthood. *Psychology & Sexuality* 13, 5 (2022), 1214–1230.
- [33] Yubo Kou, Colin M Gray, Austin Toombs, and Bonnie Nardi. 2018. The politics of titling: The representation of countries in CHI papers. In *Extended Abstracts of the 2018 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 1–10.
- [34] Arnaud Kurze, Sarah Sturken, and Steve Thwe. 2024. *Mapping Queerness in Times of Uncertainty: Stories of Struggle, Invisibility and Space*. Taylor & Francis.
- [35] Shaimaa Lazem, Danilo Giglito, Makuochi Samuel Nkwo, Hafeni Mthoko, Jessica Upani, and Anicia Peters. 2021. Challenges and paradoxes in decolonising HCI: A critical discussion. *Computer Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW)* (2021), 1–38.
- [36] Calvin A Liang, Sean A Munson, and Julie A Kientz. 2021. Embracing four tensions in human-computer interaction research with marginalized people. *ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (TOCHI)* 28, 2 (2021), 1–47.
- [37] Mia Liinason. 2020. Challenging the visibility paradigm: Tracing ambivalences in lesbian migrant women's negotiations of sexual identity. *Journal of Lesbian Studies* 24, 2 (2020), 110–125.
- [38] Emma Mawdsley. 2020. Queering development? The unsettling geographies of South–South cooperation. *Antipode* 52, 1 (2020), 227–245.
- [39] Maya Mikdashi and Jasbir K Puar. 2016. Queer theory and permanent war. *GLQ: A Journal of Lesbian and Gay Studies* 22, 2 (2016), 215–222.
- [40] Aparna Moitra, Megh Marathe, Syed Ishtiaque Ahmed, and Priyank Chandra. 2021. Negotiating intersectional non-Normative queer identities in India. In *Extended Abstracts of the 2021 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 1–6.
- [41] Kathleen Musante. 2015. Participant observation. *Handbook of methods in cultural anthropology* (2015), 251–292.
- [42] Seora Park, Hajin Lim, and Joonhwan Lee. 2024. “Some Hope, Many Despair”: Experiences of the Normalization within Online Dating among Queer Women in a Closeted Society. In *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 1–15.
- [43] Joe Phillips and Joseph Yi. 2020. Queer communities and activism in South Korea: Periphery-center currents. *Journal of homosexuality* 67, 14 (2020), 1948–1973.
- [44] Jennifer A Rode. 2011. Reflexivity in digital anthropology. In *Proceedings of the SIGCHI conference on human factors in computing systems*. 123–132.
- [45] Ari Schlesinger, W Keith Edwards, and Rebecca E Grinter. 2017. Intersectional HCI: Engaging identity through gender, race, and class. In *Proceedings of the 2017 CHI conference on human factors in computing systems*. 5412–5427.
- [46] Arathi Sriprakash and Rahul Mukhopadhyay. 2019. Reflexivity and the politics of knowledge: researchers as ‘brokers’ and ‘translators’ of educational development. In *Revisiting Actor-Network Theory in Education*. Routledge, 124–139.
- [47] Alex S. Taylor. 2011. Out there. In *Proceedings of the SIGCHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (Vancouver, BC, Canada) (CHI '11). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 685694. doi:10.1145/1978942.1979042
- [48] Jordan Taylor, Ellen Simpson, Anh-Ton Tran, Jed R Brubaker, Sarah E Fox, and Haiyi Zhu. 2024. Cruising Queer HCI on the DL: A Literature Review of LGBTQ+ People in HCI. In *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 1–21.
- [49] Barbara Tedlock. 1991. From participant observation to the observation of participation: The emergence of narrative ethnography. *Journal of anthropological research* 47, 1 (1991), 69–94.
- [50] Austin Toombs, Shad Gross, Shaowen Bardzell, and Jeffrey Bardzell. 2017. From empathy to care: a feminist care ethics perspective on long-term researcher–participant relations. *Interacting with Computers* 29, 1 (2017), 45–57.
- [51] Pooja Upadhyay, Sayan Bhattacharjee, and Shreyasha Paudel. 2024. Positionality of Researchers Identifying with the “Global South”: Shared Heritages, Ways of Thinking and Doing Research. In *Companion Publication of the 2024 Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing*. 679–683.
- [52] Michael Warner. 1991. Introduction: Fear of a Queer Planet. *Social Text* 29 (1991), 3–17.
- [53] Carla Wilson. 2001. Decolonizing Methodologies: research and indigeneous peoples. *Social Policy Journal of New Zealand* (2001), 214–218.
- [54] Peter Winch. 2015. *The idea of a social science and its relation to philosophy*. Routledge.

Received 05 December 2024; accepted 30 January 2025; revised 20 February 2025